

Numerical Analysis PhD Exam, May 2004

Do any eight of the following ten problems.

1. Let $w(x)$ be a positive integrable function on $[a, b]$. Let $p(x)$ denote the Hermite interpolant of $f(x)$ such that $d^\ell f/dx^\ell$ and $d^\ell p/dx^\ell$ coincide at distinct nodes $x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n$ in $[a, b]$ for $\ell = 0, 1$ and 2. Consider the quadrature that approximates $\int_a^b f(x)w(x) dx$ by

$$\int_a^b p(x)w(x) dx := \sum_{k=0}^n (A_k f(x_k) + A'_k f'(x_k) + A''_k f''(x_k)). \quad (1)$$

- (a) Prove that the precision of the quadrature is at least $4n + 3$ if and only if the nodes are chosen such that $\pi_{n+1}(x) = (x - x_0)(x - x_1) \cdots (x - x_n)$ satisfies

$$\int_a^b \pi_{n+1}(x)^3 q(x)w(x) dx = 0$$

for all polynomials q of degree at most n .

- (b) Prove that there cannot exist numbers $\{A_j\}, \{A'_j\}, \{A''_j\}, \{x_j\}$ such that a quadrature formula of the type (1) has precision greater than $4n + 3$.

2. To find a root of $f(x) = 0$, let $g(x) = x + cf(x)$ for some constant $c \neq 0$. If α is a root of $f(x)$ and $f'(\alpha) = 2$, for what values of c will the sequence

$$x_{n+1} = g(x_n)$$

be guaranteed to converge to α (assuming x_0 is close enough to α and f is smooth)? For what value of c will the convergence be quadratic?

3. Denote the complete and natural cubic splines interpolating $f \in C^2[a, b]$ at knots $t_0 < t_1 < \cdots < t_n$ by $s_c(t)$ and $s_n(t)$, respectively.

- (a) Prove that

$$\int_a^b |s_c''(x)|^2 dx \leq \int_a^b |f''(x)|^2 dx.$$

State an analogous inequality for s_n .

- (b) Which of the two interpolating splines has smaller “energy”, i.e., which of $\int_a^b |s_c''(x)|^2 dx$ and $\int_a^b |s_n''(x)|^2 dx$ is smaller?

4. To numerically solve the initial value problem

$$Y'(t) = f(t, Y), \quad \text{for all } t \in (0, 1), \quad (2)$$

$$Y(0) = Y_0, \quad (3)$$

consider using the Runge–Kutta type iteration

$$y_{n+1} = y_n + h(\alpha_1 k_1 + \alpha_2 k_2),$$

where $k_1 = f(t_n, y_n)$, $k_2 = f(t_n + \mu h, y_n + \mu h k_1)$, $t_n = nh$, and α_1, α_2 , and μ are three real parameters. Suppose $f(t, Y) = Y^\lambda$ for some $\lambda > 0$. Find an interval I such that for $\lambda \in I$ there are choices of the parameters $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \mu \in (0, 1)$ for which the method is of third order. For these choices of parameters, what is the order of convergence one can expect in general when the method is applied to (2)–(3) with any $f(t, Y)$?

5. Let x_m and x_{m+1} be two successive iterates when Newton's method is applied to a polynomial $p(z)$ of degree n . Prove that there is a zero of $p(z)$ in the disk

$$\{z \in \mathbb{C} : |z - x_m| \leq n|x_{m+1} - x_m|\}.$$

(Suggestion: Use $p'(z)/p(z) = \sum_{j=1}^n 1/(z - r_j)$, where $r_1, r_2, \dots, r_n$ are the roots of p .)

6. Consider the Arnoldi iteration on the Krylov spaces $\mathcal{K}_k = \text{span}\{b, Ab, A^2b, \dots, A^{k-1}b\}$ for some $b \in \mathbb{C}^m$ and $A \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times m}$, using the following algorithm:

Algorithm 1 (Arnoldi iteration)

(a) Set $q_1 = b/\|b\|_2$.

(b) For $n = 1, 2, 3, \dots$ do:

i. Set $v = Aq_n$.

ii. For $j = 1, 2, \dots, n$ do:

A. Set $h_{jn} = q_j^* v$.

B. Replace v by $v - h_{jn}q_j$.

iii. Set $h_{n+1,n} = \|v\|_2$.

iv. Set $q_{n+1} = v/h_{n+1,n}$.

Suppose the algorithm proceeds without breakdown until, for some $n < m$, it encounters $h_{n+1,n} = 0$.

(a) Show that $\mathcal{K}_n$ is an invariant subspace of A , i.e., $A\mathcal{K}_n \subseteq \mathcal{K}_n$.

(b) Show that $\mathcal{K}_n = \mathcal{K}_{n+1} = \mathcal{K}_{n+2} = \dots$.

(c) Let H_n be the $n \times n$ Hessenberg matrix whose ij -th entry ($i \leq j+1$) is the number h_{ij} computed in the algorithm. Show that each eigenvalue of H_n is an eigenvalue of A .

(d) Show that if A is nonsingular, then the solution x of $Ax = b$ lies in $\mathcal{K}_n$.

7. Let $A \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times m}$. Diagonalize the $2m \times 2m$ matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & A^* \\ A & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

using an SVD of A .

8. Consider $\mathbb{C}^{m \times n}$ with any norm topology.

(a) Let $m = n$. The map $f(A) = A^{-1}$ is defined on the (open) subset $V \subseteq \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ of all invertible matrices. Is f continuous on V ?

(b) Let $m \neq n$. The map $g(A) = A^+$ (where A^+ is the Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse) is defined on all $\mathbb{C}^{m \times n}$. Is g continuous on $\mathbb{C}^{m \times n}$?

9. Given $A \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times n}$ of full rank and $b \in \mathbb{C}^m$, consider the block 2×2 system

$$\begin{pmatrix} I & A \\ A^* & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} r \\ x \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} b \\ 0 \end{pmatrix},$$

where I is the $m \times m$ identity matrix. Show that this system has a unique solution $\begin{pmatrix} r \\ x \end{pmatrix}$, and that the vectors r and x are the residual and the solution respectively of the least squares problem: $\min_x \|b - Ax\|_2$.

10. Consider the Rayleigh quotient iteration applied to the 2×2 real matrix

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2 \end{bmatrix},$$

where $\lambda_1 \neq \lambda_2$. Find the subset $S \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ having the property that the Rayleigh quotient iteration with initial guesses in S do not converge. Is S a set of measure zero?